



# AHK Academy – HOMEWORK 2: Leadership Storytelling

## Building Speaking Skills (15 Minutes)

Teacher: Ahsan Hussain Khan

Student: Ahmet

**Focus:** Enhancing general life fluency and charisma in storytelling, with **Leadership English** integration for professional and casual settings. This exercise teaches **20 high-impact leadership vocabularies**, drills them through targeted exercises, and ends with video practice.

### Powerful Lesson

*“Great leaders don’t just manage projects—they inspire movements.”*

Use these words to command respect, rally teams, and frame engineering challenges as leadership triumphs.

### Step 1 (5 Minutes) – Learn the 20 Leadership Vocabularies

| Vocabulary       | Definition<br>(Engineering<br>Leadership Context) | Example in a Sentence                                              |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 Visionary      | Having bold, forward-thinking ideas               | “We need a <i>visionary</i> redesign to future-proof this bridge.” |
| 2 Empower        | Give team members authority and trust             | “I <i>empowered</i> the junior engineers to lead the soil tests.”  |
| 3 Accountability | Ownership of outcomes, good or bad                | “Full <i>accountability</i> ensured zero delays in reporting.”     |
| 4 Resilience     | Ability to recover from setbacks                  | “Our <i>resilience</i> turned flood damage into innovation.”       |
| 5 Decisive       | Making firm, timely decisions                     | “A <i>decisive</i> pivot saved 15% on material costs.”             |
| 6 Influence      | Ability to shape opinions without authority       | “Her <i>influence</i> aligned stakeholders in one meeting.”        |
| 7 Integrity      | Consistency between words and actions             | “ <i>Integrity</i> in data reporting built client trust.”          |
| 8 Mentorship     | Guiding others to grow professionally             | “Weekly <i>mentorship</i> sessions accelerated team skills.”       |
| 9 Agility        | Adapting quickly to change                        | “Operational <i>agility</i> kept us on schedule during storms.”    |
| 10 Alignment     | Unifying team goals and actions                   | “We achieved full <i>alignment</i> on the retrofit strategy.”      |



| Vocabulary      | Definition                             | Example                                                          |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 11 Catalyst     | Person or action that sparks change    | "The drone survey was the <i>catalyst</i> for redesign."         |
| 12 Transparency | Open, honest communication             | "Daily <i>transparency</i> updates reduced rumor and stress."    |
| 13 Ownership    | Taking full responsibility for a task  | "He took <i>ownership</i> of the cracking issue overnight."      |
| 14 Inspire      | Motivate others to exceed expectations | "Her passion <i>inspired</i> a 48-hour repair sprint."           |
| 15 Strategic    | Long-term, high-level planning         | "A <i>strategic</i> material swap cut emissions by 30%."         |
| 16 Collaborate  | Work jointly toward a shared goal      | "We <i>collaborated</i> with contractors to beat the deadline."  |
| 17 Escalate     | Raise an issue to higher authority     | "We had to <i>escalate</i> the seismic risk to the board."       |
| 18 Delegate     | Assign tasks to develop others         | "I <i>delegated</i> the sensor calibration to build confidence." |
| 19 Mitigate     | Reduce risk or negative impact         | "Early testing helped <i>mitigate</i> structural failure."       |
| 20 Legacy       | Lasting impact of your leadership      | "This highway will be our <i>legacy</i> of safety and speed."    |

## Step 2 (5 Minutes) – Solve and Apply: 3 Quick Vocabulary Drills

### Drill 1: Fill-in-the-Leadership-Arc (1 min)

Rewrite this weak story using **5 vocab words** from the list:

**Weak:** "We had a problem with the foundation. I told people what to do. It got fixed."

**Strong (you write):**

- **Hook:** "One tremor threatened to erase years of work. . ."
- **Build-up:** "I \_\_\_\_\_ the team to \_\_\_\_\_ the risk. . ."
- **Climax:** "With \_\_\_\_\_, we made a \_\_\_\_\_ call. . ."
- **Resolution:** "This became our \_\_\_\_\_ of \_\_\_\_\_."

### Drill 2: 60-Second Leadership Swap (2 min)

Pick **ONE** engineering challenge you faced.

Replace **3 ordinary verbs** with leadership vocab:

- Instead of "told" → **empower** / **delegate**



- Instead of “fixed” → **mitigate** / **catalyze**

- Instead of “helped” → **inspire** / **align**

**Example:**

Before: “I told the team to check the bolts.”

After: “I **delegated** bolt inspections to **empower** rising talent.”



### **Drill 3: One-Word Impact Close (2 min)**

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For each word below, write **1 leadership sentence** tied to an engineering win:

1. **Resilience** \_\_\_\_\_
2. **Transparency** \_\_\_\_\_
3. **Legacy** \_\_\_\_\_
4. **Catalyst** \_\_\_\_\_
5. **Influence** \_\_\_\_\_

**Example:**

**Resilience:** “Our *resilience* turned a collapsed scaffold into a safer design standard.”

### **Step 3 (5 Minutes) – Record and Send Video: “My Leadership Moment”**

**Task:** Record a **1–2 minute video** telling **one true leadership story** from your career (e.g., leading a crisis fix, mentoring a failing team, or pushing a bold idea).

**Rules:**

- Use the **Story Arc** (Hook → Build-up → Climax → Resolution)
- Include **at least 8 of the 20 vocab words** (highlight them in your mind as you speak)
- Deliver with **charisma**: varied tone, pauses, eye contact, positive energy
- Speak as if presenting to a **promotion panel** or **international conference**

**Self-Check Before Sending:**

- Did I use **8+ vocab words** naturally?
- Did I **inspire** the listener?
- Did I end with a **powerful legacy** or lesson?

**Send the video to me for feedback.**

*“Leadership is not about being in charge. It’s about taking care of those in your charge.”*